Rate card: INTERNAL ONLY

> ⚠ Never copy any of this into client-facing material (website, deck, proposals, SOW templates, emails, social posts) until the owner explicitly approves pricing for publication. Clients only ever see their own quotation.
> **Status:** v3 · 11 Nov 2026 · **Standard day rate RM1,750 approved by the owner**; other tiers derived from it · based on market research (sources at the end).
> Calculator: `internal/pricing/Quote_Calculator.xlsx`.

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1. Day rates: the basis for every price

Every fixed price = **estimated days × day rate × (1 + risk buffer)**, rounded to the nearest RM500.

Rate	RM / day	Use for
Community	**1,500**	Non-profits, education, early-stage startups, first case-study client (floor: never lower)
SME	**1,600**	SMEs (< ~RM50m revenue)
Standard	**1,750**	Default for mid-size companies and anything unclear (**approved by owner, 11 Nov 2026**)
Enterprise / GLC / government	**2,200**	Corporates, GLCs, public sector: procurement effort, governance documents, slower payment
Specialist	**2,600**	Executive strategy, AI architecture, assurance/second opinion, board workshops

- **Half day** = 55% of the day rate. **Hourly (ad hoc)** = RM250/hour (Enterprise RM325), **minimum 2 hours**.
- **Risk buffer on fixed-price builds:** +15% (clear scope, clean data) · +25% (several sources, messy data, new client systems). Never quote a build without one.
- **Why these numbers:** RM1,750 sits at the top of the local senior freelance range (RM1,000–1,600/day) and in line with the government consultant formula (≈ RM1,550–2,300/day). Solo founder at ~11 billable days/month: RM1,750 × 11 ≈ **RM19,250/month** revenue. To reach ~RM22,000 (≈ RM15,000 take-home after tools, insurance, accountant, EPF and tax), aim for **12–13 billable days** or a mix with Enterprise-rate work. Below RM1,500 the business doesn't sustain itself.

2. Packages (typical scope · days · price)

Prices assume the **Standard** rate (RM1,750/day). Advisory: days × rate, no buffer. Builds: days × rate × 1.15 buffer. All rounded to RM500. Re-run in the calculator for other client types and messier scopes. Ranges = S / M / L.

Advisory (advice only: client or another vendor builds)

Package	Scope	Days	Price (RM)
Data health check (entry offer)	2 interviews, review of 1–2 key reports/systems, 5-page findings, 1 readout	2	**3,500** fixed
Readiness audit S	SME: 3–4 interviews, up to 3 systems, roadmap	5	**9,000**
Readiness audit M	Mid-size: 6–8 interviews, up to 6 systems, scored opportunities, roadmap, readout	8	**14,000**

Package	Scope	Days	Price (RM)
Readiness audit L	Enterprise/ GLC: multiple departments, architecture options, business case	12–15	**26,500–33,000** (Enterprise rate)
Data & AI strategy and roadmap	Leadership workshops, current state, target state, 12–18 month roadmap, business case	10–15	**22,000–39,000** (Enterprise to Specialist rate)
Tool / vendor selection	Requirements, shortlist, demos, scoring, recommendation (vendor-neutral)	5–8	**9,000–14,000**
AI governance & usage policy	AI usage policy, risk and PDPA review of AI use, approval process, 1 briefing	3–4	**5,500–7,000**
Second opinion / project assurance	Review a proposal, design or stalled project; written opinion	2–3	**5,000–8,000** (Specialist rate)

Package	Scope	Days	Price (RM)
Advisory retainer ("fractional head of data")	On-call adviser: steering meetings, reviews, vendor oversight	2 d/mo · 4 d/mo	**4,000 / mo · 7,500 / mo** (min. 3 months; small premium for availability)

Audit credit: 50% of a readiness audit fee is credited against a build signed within **60 days** of the readout. Strong reason to start with the audit.

Build

Package	Typical scope	Days	Price (RM)
Dashboard S / M	S: 1 clean source, up to 5 pages · M: 2–3 sources, modelled data, role-based access	5 / 10–12	**10,000 / 20,000–24,000**
Workflow automation S / M	S: 1 workflow (e.g. report emailed automatically) · M: approvals with 2–3 systems	3 / 6–8	**6,000 / 12,000–16,000**
Data pipelines & integrations	Per source system, scheduled and monitored	4–6 per source	**8,000–12,000 per source**
Data platform S / M / L	S: 2–3 sources + warehouse + 1 dashboard · M: 4–6 sources, data model, 3–5 dashboards · L: many sources,	20 / 35 / 50+	**40,500 / 70,500 / 100,500+**

Package	Typical scope	Days	Price (RM)
	governance, multiple teams		
AI assistant S / M	S: proof of concept on one document set, 1 channel · M: production assistant, access control, evaluation, monitoring	8 / 18–22	**16,000 / 36,000–44,500**
Custom tool / internal platform	Scoped per project	8–30	**16,000–60,500**

Training

Workshops are priced per session, not per day: they include preparation, materials and follow-up (≈ 2–4 days of effort).

Package	Price (RM)	Notes
AI workshop, half day (up to 20 people, in-house)	**4,500**	Within HRD Corp in-house cap (RM10,500/group/day) if datawazi registers as an HRD Corp training provider
AI workshop, full day	**8,500**	Includes workbook and prompt playbook
Leadership AI briefing (2–3 hours, executives)	**5,000**	Specialist rate
Extra cohort, same content	**-20%**	

Run (managed support retainers, monthly in advance, min. 3 months)

Tier	Included	Response (business hours)	RM / month
Essential	8 hours · monitoring · monthly report	Next business day	**2,500**
Standard	16 hours · monitoring · small changes · quarterly review	4 hours for P1	**4,500**
Priority	32 hours · everything above · monthly review	2 hours for P1	**8,000**

Unused hours roll over **one month** only. Extra hours at the hourly rate.

3. Rules

Situation	Rule
Minimum engagement	RM3,500 (the health check)
Change requests	Priced at the client's day rate × days, signed before work starts
Rush (start within 5 working days, or weekend work)	+25%
Multi-phase commitment (2+ phases signed together)	-10% on later phases
Non-profit / education	Community rate (already discounted; no further discount)
Case-study discount	Up to -10% in exchange for a published, named case study (written approval)
GLC / government	Enterprise rate; PO before work; allow 30–60 day payment terms; replace deposit with milestones
Travel	Klang Valley included.

Situation	Rule
	Elsewhere: travel and accommodation at cost
Third-party costs	Cloud, licences and AI usage: client pays the vendor directly, or passed through at cost
Never	Discount the day rate itself to win work. Reduce scope instead ("we can do S for that budget")

Payment schedules: `internal/finance/BILLING.md` (audits/workshops 100% upfront · builds 50/50 or 40/40/20 · retainers monthly in advance).

4. Quick sanity checks

- **Intake Q18 budget bands:** `< RM50k` → health check, audit S/M, dashboard, automation, AI POC, workshops · `RM50–150k` → platform S/M, AI assistant M, strategy · `RM150k+` → platform L, multi-phase programmes.
- **Government formula check** (PK 3.2: fee = basic salary × 2.7 × time): a RM12,000 senior → ≈ RM1,550/day; a RM18,000 principal → ≈ RM2,300/day. Our Standard (RM1,750) and Enterprise (RM2,200) rates sit within that band.
- **Market check:** freelancers RM1,000–1,600/day; senior specialists RM1,450–2,250/day; vendor packages: dashboard from RM10k, pipelines RM30–80k, warehouse RM150k+. A consultancy that designs, builds, documents and hands over sits at or slightly above the top of the freelance range.
- **Review** these rates every 6 months, and after the first 3 projects compare estimated vs actual days (`delivery/run/project-close-review.md`).

5. Research sources (Nov 2026)

- Salaries: Nodeflair, Sigma School, Seekers salary guide
- Freelance rates: Twine (KL data engineers), FreelanceMY 2026, Secondtalent
- Government formula: PK 3.2 Kos Perkhidmatan Perunding, JDN ICT cost catalogue
- Regional: Paymetric Singapore contractor rates, Pertama Partners AI consultant rates
- Training: HRDF claimable rates, MDEC AI skills training
- Project prices: Gotchaa Lab data analytics services

All web figures are directional (vendor and aggregator sites); verify against real quotes as you win and lose work.